Murad Latifov

PhD Candidate
Department of Economics
Texas Tech University
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Education

- **Texas Tech University** *May 2027(expected)*
  Ph.D. in Economics
- **Azerbaijan State University of Economics** *2023*
  B.S. in Finance (with Honors)

Research Interests

Sports Economics, Labor Economics, Urban Economics, Economics of Crime

Research Experience

Working Papers

- **The Impact of Professional Sports Franchise Movements on Urban Crime Rates**
  Under review, The Journal of Urban Economics

  – While municipalities often justify large public subsidies for professional sports franchises through expected social benefits, the long-term externalities on public safety remain largely underexplored. This paper investigates the long-term effect of professional sports team entries and exits on local urban crime rates. The findings demonstrate that the crime externalities of professional sports are highly sensitive to market saturation. In solo markets, franchise movements generate significant and symmetric shocks. The arrival of a city's first major franchise structurally increases overall crime, whereas the departure of a sole franchise leads to a proportional decrease. However, in established multi-team markets, the marginal addition or loss of a franchise yields no statistically significant changes in crime.

Works in Progress

- **How a World Cup Changes Superstar Demand: Evidence from Messi and MLS Resale Prices (with James Kemper and Lissa De Mesa)**

- **Who Captures the Data Center Windfall?**

- **The Effect of Minimum Wage Policies on Reservation Wages**

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

- ECO 2305: Principles of Economics — *Fall 2025, Spring 2026*
- ECO 3161: Excel Basics - Online — *Summer 2026*
- ECO 2301: Principles of Microeconomics — *Fall 2026*

Teaching Assistant

- ECO 2305: Principles of Economics — *Summer 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025*
- ECO 2305: Principles of Economics - Online — *Fall 2023, Fall 2024*
- ECO 2301: Principles of Microeconomics — *Summer 2025*
- ECO 2301: Principles of Microeconomics - Online — *Fall 2024*
- ECO 2302: Principles of Macroeconomics - Online — *Fall 2023, Fall 2024*
- Economics Tutoring Center — *Spring 2024, Fall 2025*
- ECO 3161: Excel Basics - Online — *Spring 2025*
- ECO 3361: Excel for Economists - Online — *Spring 2024, Spring 2025*

Conference Presentations

- **3rd Annual UMBC Sports Economics Conference** Baltimore, MD *June 2026*
- **Southern Economics Association, 96th Annual Meeting** Houston, TX *November 2026*

Scholarships and Awards

- **Dr. Rashid B. Al-Hmoud Competitive Scholarship in Economics** *Fall 2024 - present*
- **Collaborative for Sport Data Science Student Conference Travel Award** *Fall 2026*

Technical Skills

Developer Tools: R, Stata, LaTeX, GTAP, Microsoft Office
Languages: English, Turkish, Azerbaijani

References

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